

negative adverbial

A phrase that acts as an **adverb** and has a negative meaning, e.g. **not only**, **not until**.

non-defining relative clause

A clause that starts with a **relative pronoun** (such as **who** or **which**). It gives non-essential information about the **main clause**.
see also **defining relative clause**

non-gradable adjective

An adjective that cannot be used in the **comparative** form and can only be used with certain **adverbs of degree** (such as **absolutely**).
see also **gradable adjective**

non-grading adverb

An **adverb of degree** that can be used with **non-gradable adjectives**.

noun

A word that refers to a person, place, or thing.

noun phrase

A **noun**, **pronoun**, or a number of words that are linked to a noun, e.g. **the blue house**.

object

A **noun** or **pronoun** that follows a **verb** or a **preposition**.

object pronoun

A pronoun that usually follows a **verb** or a **preposition**, e.g. **me**, **them**.

object question

A question where the question word is the **object**, e.g. "What" in **What did you say?**

open question

A question that cannot be answered with "yes" or "no" and starts with a question word (such as **when** or **who**).
see also **closed question**

ordinal number

The numbers used for ordering, e.g. **first**, **second**.
see also **cardinal number**

participle

The form of a **verb** used to make **compound tenses**.
see also **past participle** and **present participle**

particle

A word that follows a **verb** to form a **phrasal verb**.

passive voice

Indicates that the person or thing affected by the action is the **subject** of the **verb**.
see also **active voice**

past continuous

A **tense** that is formed with **was** or **were** and the **present participle**, e.g. **was doing**.
It expresses an ongoing action in the past.

past participle

The **participle** form of a **verb** that is used to make **perfect tenses** and the passive, e.g. **walked**, **done**, **eaten**.

past perfect

A **tense** that is formed with **had** and the **past participle**, e.g. **had done**. It expresses a completed action that happened before another action or state in the past.

past perfect continuous

A **tense** that is formed with **had been** and the **present participle**, e.g. **had been doing**. It expresses an ongoing action that happened before another action or state in the past.

past simple

A **tense** that consists only of the past form of a **verb**, e.g. **walked**, **said**, **ate**. It expresses a completed action in the past.

perfect

Perfect **tenses** express a link between two times, e.g. the **present perfect** links the past with the present.

person

The form of a **pronoun** that shows who is speaking (**I**, **we**),

who is being spoken to (**you**) or who or what is being mentioned (**he**, **she**, **it**, **they**).
Verbs also reflect person, e.g. **am** is the first person singular form of **be**.

personal pronoun

A word that refers to people or things that have already been mentioned, e.g. **he**, **they**.

phrasal verb

A combination of **verb** + **particle** that is always used together and has a different meaning from the verb on its own, e.g. **make up** meaning "invent."

plural

The form of a word used when there is more than one of something, e.g. **books**, **they**.
see also **singular**

positive

A **clause** that expresses what someone or something is or does. It does not contain a negative word.
see also **negative**

possessive determiner

A word that comes before a **noun** and shows belonging, e.g. **my**, **our**, **his**.

possessive pronoun

A word that replaces a **noun** and shows belonging, e.g. **mine**, **ours**, **his**.

prefix

Letters at the beginning of a word that change its meaning, e.g. "re-" in **replace**.
see also **suffix**

preposition

A short word that links two **nouns** or **pronouns** to show a relationship, e.g. **to**, **at**, **with**, **from**.

prepositional phrase

A phrase that starts with a **preposition**, e.g. **on the bus**, **at five o'clock**.

present continuous

A **tense** that is formed with the present of **be** and the **present participle**, e.g. **is doing**.
It expresses an ongoing action in the present.

present participle

The **participle** form of a **verb** that is used to make **continuous tenses**, e.g. **walking**, **doing**.

present perfect

A **tense** that is formed with the present of **have** and the **past participle**, e.g. **have done**.
It expresses an action that started in the past and is still continuing or that happened in the past but has a result in the present.

present perfect continuous

A **tense** that is formed with **has / have been** and the **present participle**, e.g. **has / have been doing**. It expresses an ongoing action that started in the past and is still continuing.

present simple

A **tense** that consists only of the present form of a **verb**, e.g. **walk**, **say**, **eat**. It expresses a general truth about the present.

pronoun

A word that replaces a **noun**, when the noun has already been mentioned, e.g. **it**, **that**.

proper noun

A noun that is the name of a person, place, day, etc., e.g. **Maria**, **France**, **Sunday**.

quantifier

A word that usually comes before a **noun** and expresses a quantity or amount, e.g. **several**, **many**, **much**.

question

A **sentence** that asks for something, usually information. The **verb** usually comes before the **subject**.